



Type 79 submachine gun

The **Type 79** (Chinese: 1979年式衝鋒槍; pinyin: 1979 Niánshì Chōngfēng Qiāng; lit. '1979 Year Type Submachine Gun')^[1] but more commonly known as (Chinese: 79式衝鋒槍; pinyin: 79 Shì Chōngfēng Qiāng; lit. '79 Type Submachine Gun') is the first generation indigenous submachine gun made in China. This development came in coincidence after the start of the Sino-Soviet split.^[2]

The submachine gun was certificated in 1979 and entered mass production in 1983.^[3]

History

In August 1965, the People's Liberation Army (PLA) General Staff Department issued a requirement for a weapon that could be used by the Chinese military in a jungle environment.^[1] The 208th Research Institute of China Ordnance Industry was tasked to head the design.^[1] The project began to develop a prototype of "jungle submachine gun," and the research and development program began in 1966. It immediately encountered turmoil of the Culture Revolution in the same year. The project was repeatedly canceled between 1966 and 1970. It was reinstated in March 1970, and its prototype and testing phase began between 1971 and 1978.^{[1][4]} Between 1971 and 1975, the designer identified mechanical problems during torture tests, which were associated with the immense chamber pressure of firing Chinese steel-core 7.62×25 mm ammunition. Type 79 had several design changes to fix the problem identified.^[5] The weapon was certificated in 1979, hence the name.^{[1][4]}

The weapon gained a notorious reputation when it was used by factions working for Lin Biao during his coup and the Gang of Four during the Cultural Revolution. In 1971, the development

Type 79 submachine gun



Type	<u>Submachine gun</u>
Place of origin	China
Service history	
In service	1979–present
Used by	<u>People's Republic of China</u>
Production history	
Designer	Liu Zhitong
Designed	1970–1979
Manufacturer	<u>China North Industries Corporation</u> and <u>China South</u>
Produced	1981–1992
No. built	at least 200,000
Variants	See <u>Variants</u>
Specifications	
Mass	1.75 kg
Length	740 mm stock extended/470mm stock closed
Barrel length	250 mm
Cartridge	7.62×25 mm Tokarev
Action	<u>Gas-operated short-stroke piston</u> , closed <u>rotating bolt</u>
Rate of fire	1000 rounds/min
Muzzle velocity	515 m/s
Effective firing range	200 m
Feed system	20-round <u>box magazine</u>
Sights	Rear sight notch

prototypes and design diagrams were stolen by the Lin Biao's coup participants, and hundreds of reverse-engineered copies were found after the coup failed. In 1976, the prototype productions were partially relocated to Shanghai as per an unusual request from the Ministry of Defense. The illicit intention was to manufacture the weapon for the Gang of Four in Shanghai, where the Gang headquartered.^[4]

The Type 79 entered service with the People's Liberation Army after initial production was made from 1981 to 1982.^[6] During the war with Vietnam, Chinese soldiers on recon operations used the Type 79 as their main weapon, together with the Type 64.^[1] However, PLA feedback indicated the excessive rate of fire, limited magazine capacity, and reliability issues in jungle environments, including problems of jamming, making the weapon unsuitable for jungle warfare. The PLA decided to drop the Type 79 as the main submachine gun.^{[7][4]}

The weapon found immediate acceptance within the People's Armed Police and Public Security Police forces after the PLA phased them out of service. The weapon was extremely popular in the police force due to its gas-operated, closed-bolt design.^[1] The weapon is extremely accurate in semi-automatic fire mode despite being a submachine gun with high rate of fire. The reliability issue was not significant in urban environments,^[8] and subsequent modifications to the design resolved many earlier reported problems.^[1]

The Type 79 is one of the most significant weapon designs in China. From 1981 to 1992, more than 200,000 Type 79s were made.^[9]

Due to the large production run, Type 79 and its modernized variants are ubiquitous in Chinese police forces. In the early 2000s, Type 79s still in service were retrofitted with railed fore-ends to equip them with tactical accessories like gunsights and new muzzle brake devices.^[10] This was first seen with the Guangzhou Public Security Police.^[10] Other police forces that adopted the modernized Type 79s included the Shenzhen, Dongguan and Panyu Public Security Police forces.^[11]

Replacement

The JH-16-1, BJC-16 and CS/LS7 were part of a weapon development program initiated by the Chinese Ministry of Public Security to acquire a new type of submachine gun, replacing the Type 79.^{[12][13][14]} All three submachine guns were introduced around 2017 and chambered in 9x19mm.

After trials, the CS/LS7 was selected to be the next-generation submachine gun for the Chinese police force, and was first showcased on the 70th anniversary of the People's Republic of China parade.^[15]

In PLA service, the Type 79 was replaced by the QCW-05 in 2001.^[16]

Design

From 1971 to 1975, the prototypes failed twice in various torture tests, forcing the design committee to redesign it.^{[17][18]} This was mainly because the design of the chamber could not handle the pressure of 7.62x25 Tokarev ammunition.^[18]

From the 1981 pilot production, the total production of the Type 79 was nearly 200,000 until 1992 under Liu Zhitong.^[1] The highest years of production were between 1988 and 1991. During that period the Type 79 was produced at a rate of more than 30,000 per year. The developmental period of Type 79 was 15 years with a staff of over 70 people.^[1] The design was made for use with the PLA, keeping its weight light for jungle warfare operations.^[7]

The Type 79 fires 7.62 millimeter caliber steel-cored pistol bullets in either automatic or semiautomatic mode. The gun is a gas-operated rotating closed-bolt action with short stroke gas piston, located above the barrel, with a foldable butt stock.^[6] The bolt group and fire selector is influenced from the design of the Type 56 assault rifle, with the receiver and stock made from stamped steel.^[6] Setting it to "1" makes the weapon fire on single shot while setting it to "2" makes the weapon fire in bursts.^[4] Sights can be used to fire up to 100 and 200 meters.^[17]

The extended magazine housing serves as the *de facto* forward grip.^[7]

Variants

ACE Mod

The first project to upgrade the Type 79 was in 2000 when Hong Kong weapon designer Lee Ka-Ho (Chinese: 李家豪) was tasked to create a conversion kit that would allow the user to attach a SureFire-type tac light and a laser sight.^[11] This kit was used by the Guangzhou and Dongguan Public Security Police.^[11]

PEAK 79

Lee Ka-Ho continued to work on the first conversion kit, which resulted in the creation of another variant known as PEAK 79.^[11] This was first shown to the public at the first China International Police Equipment Expo in 2002, which was subsequently adopted by the Shenzhen Public Security Police in the same year.^[11] The PEAK 79 consists of a Heckler & Koch MP5-type fore-end with a SureFire tac light built in with the addition of a C-MORE red dot sight.^[11]

Introduced in 2008, WTW-79H is the simplified version of the PEAK 79 that allows for the installation of a tac light and laser sight.^[11]

TAPS79

The TAPS79 (known as the **Tactical Adapter Platform System for Type 79 SMG**)^[19] is built with provisions for MIL-STD-1913 Picatinny rails and can have an OKO 8W red dot sight attached on the upper receiver.^[11] They were created at the same time as the PEAK 79, but TAPS 79 was not made public until working samples were exhibited in 2003.^[11] Testing on Type 79s with TAPS79 equipped did not finish until the end of 2003.^[11] It's known to be used by the Foshan and Guangzhou Public Security Police forces.^[11] Some models using the kit were also equipped with a corner assist shooting device mounted on the red dot scope.^[11]

The TAPS79 has five iterations.^[11]

MAPS79

Lee's improvement versions of TAPS79, except that it has a chassis, including modular stock, that can be used to replace the Type 79's original furniture.^{[20][11]}

Unnamed Test Kit

In 2014, weapons designer Wang Jie (Chinese: 王杰) tested a conversion kit that allows for the installation of a new set of rails over the barrel and a collapsible stock.^[11]

Defender series

In 2014, Wang Jie produced another modification kit featuring an arrow-shaped handguard and a telescopic gun stock. Two types of Defender kits are available on the market in China, the regular kit and the *Centurion* kit.^[11]

Operational Briefcase

The Type 79 was reported to be tested in an operational briefcase-type device, equipped with a laser sight for aiming.^[11] As of 2014, it was reported to have completed combat trials with Chinese police forces, including those stationed at the Diaoyutai State Guesthouse.^[11]

Chengying series

In the early 2020s, a new overhaul kit named **Chengying** (Chinese: 承影) became popular with the Chinese police force. The kit features a new lightweight M-LOK handguard, three new options of gunstocks, a new muzzle brake, a new pistol grip, an extended magazine, and a new ambidextrous magazine release mechanism for the magazine well. The Chengying kit drastically improved the ergonomics of the Type 79.^[11]

See also

- QCW-05
- CS/LS7

References

1. "1979年式冲锋枪 —— 《枪炮世界》 " (<http://pewpewpew.work/china/smg/79/79smg.htm>). *Guns' World*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20111110135957/http://firearmsworld.net/china/smg/79/79smg.htm>) from the original on 10 November 2011. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
2. "NORINCO Type 79 Submachine Gun (SMG) - China" (https://www.militaryfactory.com/smallarms/detail.asp?smallarms_id=471). *Militaryfactory.com*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20170615035535/http://www.militaryfactory.com/smallarms/detail.asp?smallarms_id=471) from the original on 15 June 2017. Retrieved 19 March 2019.

3. "Chinese Defence Today :: Type 79, 7.62 mm Submachine Gun" (https://web.archive.org/web/20021206140446/http://www.sinodefence.com/army/individual/submachine_79.asp). 6 December 2002. Archived from the original (http://www.sinodefence.com/army/individual/submachine_79.asp) on 6 December 2002. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
4. "中国特警战斗利器：1979年式冲锋枪探秘(组图) 新浪军事 新浪网" (<http://mil.news.sina.com.cn/p/2007-06-11/0802448977.html>). *Mil.news.sina.com.cn*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190330055110/http://mil.news.sina.com.cn/p/2007-06-11/0802448977.html>) from the original on 30 March 2019. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
5. Guttman, Jon (7 June 2021). "China's Type 79 Submachine Gun" (<https://www.historynet.com/china-type-79-submachine-gun/>). *HistoryNet*.
6. "Type 79 submachine gun (PR China)" (<https://modernfirearms.net/en/submachine-guns/china-submachine-guns/tip-79-eng/>). *Modern Firearms*. 27 October 2010. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20181021064007/http://modernfirearms.net/en/submachine-guns/china-submachine-guns/tip-79-eng/>) from the original on 21 October 2018. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
7. "Top 5 Submachine Guns Used by China's Military and Police" (<https://www.tactical-life.com/firearms/top-5-submachine-guns-china/>). *Tactical-life.com*. 12 January 2015. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190330044654/https://www.tactical-life.com/firearms/top-5-submachine-guns-china/>) from the original on 30 March 2019. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
8. "The Weapons and Tactics keeping the Olympics safe -" (<https://www.thefirearmblog.com/blog/2008/03/01/the-weapons-and-tactics-keeping-the-olympics-safe/>). *Thefirearmblog.com*. 1 March 2008. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190330044410/https://www.thefirearmblog.com/blog/2008/03/01/the-weapons-and-tactics-keeping-the-olympics-safe/>) from the original on 30 March 2019. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
9. "Archived copy" (http://www.airforceworld.com/a/20151108/2780_4.html). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190324123654/http://www.airforceworld.com/a/20151108/2780_4.html) from the original on 2019-03-24. Retrieved 2019-05-31.
10. "Chinese SWAT with Modded Type 79 Submachine Guns -" (<https://www.thefirearmblog.com/blog/2018/03/02/chinese-swat-modded-type-79-submachine-guns/>). *Thefirearmblog.com*. 2 March 2018. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190330044600/https://www.thefirearmblog.com/blog/2018/03/02/chinese-swat-modded-type-79-submachine-guns/>) from the original on 30 March 2019. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
11. "79式冲锋枪 的升级改造" (<http://pewpewpew.work/china/smg/79/79smgug.htm>). *Guns' World*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20181001012315/http://firearmsworld.net/china/smg/79/79smgug.htm>) from the original on 2018-10-01. Retrieved 2019-05-31.
12. "The JH16-1: China's New 9×19 Subgun" (<https://www.overtdefense.com/2018/06/10/jh16-1-chinas-new-9x19-subgun/>). *Overtdefense.com*. 10 June 2018. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190330045320/https://www.overtdefense.com/2018/06/10/jh16-1-chinas-new-9x19-subgun/>) from the original on 30 March 2019. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
13. "Weapons: China Leaves James Bond Behind" (<https://www.strategypage.com/htm/htw/20180621.aspx>). *Strategypage.com*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190330044713/https://www.strategypage.com/htm/htw/20180621.aspx>) from the original on 30 March 2019. Retrieved 19 March 2019.
14. "BJC16型冲锋枪" (<http://pewpewpew.work/china/smg/bjc16/bjc16.htm>). *Guns' World* (in Chinese).
15. "CS/LS7型冲锋枪" (<http://pewpewpew.work/china/smg/cs/ls7/cs/ls7.htm>). *Guns' World*.
16. "PLA Infantry Weapons: Small Arms of the World's Largest Army" (<http://www.sadefensejournal.com/wp/?p=2649>). *Sadefensejournal.com*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190330044632/http://www.sadefensejournal.com/wp/?p=2649>) from the original on 30 March 2019. Retrieved 19 March 2019.

17. "曾被反革命重用：中国1979年式冲锋枪探秘(图)_网易新闻" (http://war.163.com/07/0612/08/3GP9MMS300011232_all.html). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190330044322/http://war.163.com/07/0612/08/3GP9MMS300011232_all.html) from the original on 2019-03-30. Retrieved 2019-05-31.
18. "Archived copy" (http://www.airforceworld.com/a/20151108/2780_2.html). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190324121950/http://www.airforceworld.com/a/20151108/2780_2.html) from the original on 2019-03-24. Retrieved 2019-05-31.
19. "'79式'冲锋枪：老骥伏枥，烈士暮年！ | 战术控 | GearKr旗客" (<http://gearkr.com/?p=76961>).
20. "中国特警装备新冲锋枪酷似美制枪械 却是79式魔改|中国|扩展性|冲锋枪_新浪军事_新浪网" (<https://mil.news.sina.com.cn/jssd/2019-05-28/doc-ihvhiqay1991994.shtml>).

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Type_79_submachine_gun&oldid=1287778132"